Bal Bharati
PUBLIC SCHOOL
BRIJ VIHAR, GHAZIABAD

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP): FRONT OFFICE MANAGEMENT TEAM

1. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to ensure that the Front Office of every Bal Bharati Public School functions as a professional, efficient, welcoming, and culturally aligned interface for parents, students, staff, visitors, and external stakeholders.
The Front Office plays a vital role in shaping the first impression of the school; hence, this SOP establishes uniform standards of communication, behaviour, documentation, security, and service quality across all BBPS units.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

a) Front Office Executives / Receptionists
b) Office Assistants & Administrative Support
c) Visitor Handling Staff
d) Coordinators involved in telephonic, email or walk-in interactions
e) Any staff temporarily assigned Front Office responsibilities

It covers:

i. In-person interactions
ii. Telephonic communication
iii. Email / written communication
iv. Visitor management
v. Emergency response protocol
vi. Record keeping and documentation

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3. Objectives

a) Ensure a consistent, courteous, safe, and efficient experience for all stakeholders entering the school.
b) Strengthen parent–school partnership through clear, polite, and responsible communication.
c) Maintain high standards of professionalism aligned with CES values of Continuous Development, Cultural Synthesis, and Partnership with Parents.
d) Support school leadership by providing accurate information, well-organised records, and timely administrative assistance.
e) Promote emotional intelligence, composure, and teamwork within the Front Office.

4. Core Principles

a) The Front Office is the face of the school — every interaction must reflect dignity, warmth, and responsibility.
b) Courtesy, Accuracy and timely response ensure Professionalism.
c) Empathy is essential, but it must be balanced with rules and school policies.
d) Thinking before responding ensures clarity, fairness, and control.
e) Confidentiality must be maintained in all parents, student, and staff matters.
f) Security and child protection norms override all other considerations

5. Roles & Responsibilities

5.1 Front Office Executive

a) Greet visitors, parents, and students with courtesy.
b) Maintain Visitor Register/ERP entries.
c) Handle phone calls, route calls appropriately, and accurately record messages.
d) Provide factual information based on approved school communication only.
e) Ensure waiting areas are clean, comfortable, and organised.

5.2 Administrative/Office Assistant

a) Manage internal file movement, documentation, and dispatch.
b) Support fee counter coordination, issue certificates, and assist with admissions paperwork.
c) Maintain inventories related to front office (stationery, forms, registers).
d) Assist in circular distribution and collating feedback from parents/students.

5.3 Administrative Officer

a) Supervise daily functioning of the Front Office.
b) Conduct periodic training of staff on behavioural norms, communication protocols, and emergency handling.
c) Ensure timely submission of daily reports to the Principal/Vice Principal.
d) Review visitor feedback and ensure grievance redressal.

6. Professional Conduct Standards

6.1 Grooming & Appearance

a) Follow the prescribed dress code.
b) Maintain neat hair, minimal accessories, and a clean workspace.
c) Wear school ID card at all times.
d) Avoid strong perfumes or casual wear.

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6.2 Posture & Body Language

a) Sit upright and attentive.
b) Maintain a friendly expression and calm demeanour.
c) Avoid crossing arms, leaning back excessively, or showing impatience.
d) Keep mobile phones in silent mode (personal calls discouraged during duty hours).

7. Communication Guidelines

7.1 In-Person Interactions

a) Stand up to greet senior officials, parents, or visitors.
b) Maintain eye contact and a welcoming tone.
c) Provide clear, concise, and factual responses.
d) If unsure, please communicate.
e) "Let me confirm this information and get back to you shortly."
f) Escort visitors to designated areas instead of pointing directions.

7.2 Telephonic Communication

a) Answer calls within three rings.
b) Standard greeting:
c) "Good morning/Good afternoon, Bal Bharati Public School. How may I assist you?"
d) Maintain a pleasant but firm tone.
e) Record and share messages promptly with concerned staff.
f) For sensitive matters (discipline, fees, academics) — connect to authorised personnel only.

7.3 **Email / Written Communication**

a) **Maintain official email etiquette.**
b) **Respond within school's approved timeliness (24 hours unless urgent).**
c) **Use approved templates for certificates, letters, and acknowledgements.**
d) **Ensure no personal opinions or unverified information is conveyed.**

8. Active Listening Standards

a) **Give full attention to the speaker.**
b) **Avoid multitasking while someone is speaking.**
c) **Allow stakeholders to finish before responding.**
d) **Confirm the query by repeating it.**
e) **Maintain neutrality in tone even during emotionally charged conversations.**

9. Handling Difficult Situations

9.1 **Responding vs Reacting**

a) **Respond calmly after a pause.**
b) **If emotions escalate, politely propose a time-bound break.**

Example: "May I request a few minutes to check the details and respond appropriately?"

9.2 **Managing Angry Visitors or Parents**

a) **Remain seated, composed, and attentive.**
b) **Do not argue or contradict immediately.**
c) **Listen fully before replying.**
d) **If needed, escalate to Principal/Vice Principal discreetly.**

9.3 **Confidentiality**

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Never discuss student performance, staff matters, fee details, or complaints publicly or in waiting areas.

10. Documentation & Record Keeping

a) **Maintain updated:**
- **Visitor Registers**
- **Communication Logs**
- **Gate Pass Records**
- **Lost-and-found Register**
- **Leave/Permission Slips**
- **Daily Front Office Report**

b) **Ensure neat, legible entries and secure storage.**
c) **Digitize records wherever school ERP mandates.**

11. Handling Emergencies

Front Office must know the school's Emergency Response Plan.

11.1 **Medical Emergency**

a) **Inform Infirmary immediately.**
b) **Alert the Class Teacher and Admin Officer.**
c) **Call parent using registered contact only.**

11.2 **Fire / Evacuation**

a) **Activate emergency alarm as per protocol.**
b) **Guide visitors to evacuation routes.**
c) **Provide support to Disaster Management Committee.**

11.3 **Security Breach**

Immediately alert:

- **Principal**
- **Security Officer**
- **Admin Officer**

Record incident in Security Register

12. Continuous Improvement & Training

- **Participate in periodic training sessions on:**
  - **Soft skills**
  - **Parent handling**
  - **ERP usage**
  - **Child safeguarding**
  - **Crisis communication**

Provide monthly feedback to the Principal on challenges and improvement areas

Disclaimer: This SOP is meant for internal use by employees of Bal Bharati Public Schools under Child Education Society. It does not create any legal rights or obligations and may be updated periodically by the Management.

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